KELLY SIMER

Software Engineer | Reliability & Legal Operations Specialist

Las Vegas, NV • 415-261-1007 • kellyjsimer@gmail.com

linkedin.com/in/kelly-simer • github.com/solaranoir

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software engineer with a legal background (J.D.) and a decade of regulatory, compliance, and legal operations experience, combined with full-stack engineering, distributed systems, and production reliability expertise. Proven track record investigating production incidents, engineering automated data pipelines, and architecting internal workflow tools. Experienced across high-scale commerce and blockchain platforms with core strengths in Python, React, Snowflake, event-driven architectures, and AI-assisted developer workflows.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Software & Reliability Engineering: Python, JavaScript, React, MySQL, Snowflake, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, event-driven architecture, API development, CI/CD, Jenkins, Docker, incident response & root cause analysis (RCA), cross-system debugging

Legal Operations & Regulatory: Regulatory filings (Form B/C) & compliance administration, corporate licensing, contract lifecycle & NDA workflows, due diligence, legal drafting, insurance regulatory analysis (CPCU)

Cross-Disciplinary & AI Tooling: AI-assisted engineering (Claude, Cursor, GitHub Copilot), custom AI agent & skill automation, technical proposal writing, cross-functional engineering alignment

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer - Recharge

Oct 2024 - Aug 2026

- Implemented full-stack reliability enhancements across React frontend services, Python backend systems, and event-driven architectures within a large-scale commerce platform.
- Conducted cross-system debugging, log analysis, and root cause analysis (RCA) to remediate complex production incidents and escalations.
- Engineered automated Python and Snowflake data integrity workflows to identify and correct anomalies, including automated alerting pipelines.
- Spearheaded initiatives to refine merchant-facing event timelines by reducing noise, optimizing content payloads, and surfacing actionable information.
- Resolved escalations regarding Shopify-imported data synchronization and merchant data export reliability.
- Authored technical proposals and coordinated architectural changes across feature teams and product reliability stakeholders.
- Integrated AI-assisted workflows (Claude, Cursor, Copilot) to accelerate debugging cycles, code review turnaround, and technical documentation.

Associate Software Engineer in Test - Recharge

Jan 2022 - Oct 2024

- Supported Payments, Subscriptions, and Engineering Escalations teams. Transitioned QA responsibilities into continuous automation and production-focused engineering.
- Designed and executed test plans validating complex business workflows across multi-tier staging and production environments.
- Developed test automation pipelines and managed end-to-end test data suites for cross-team integration testing.
- Managed scheduled deployment pipelines, executing pre-release validation and post-deployment verification.

Release Manager / Test Engineer - BlockApps

Mar 2018 - Jan 2022

- Promoted from Test Engineer to Release Manager for an Ethereum-based blockchain platform.
- Led release coordination, feature verification, and production rollout schedules across distributed network nodes.
- Built automated testing scripts and Jenkins CI/CD pipelines to ensure release predictability across rapidly growing engineering teams.
- Established bug triage processes, defect prioritization frameworks, and QA operational standards.

- Investigated distributed platform defects across diverse node configurations to resolve root causes and improve network stability.

Front End Software Engineer - Mercy Corps (RRIMA Project)

May 2016 - Dec 2016

- Developed custom Python/Django dashboard applications supporting refugee response operations in the Aegean region.
- Built responsive user interfaces integrating Leaflet mapping, TimelineJS visualization, ChartJS analytics, and hosted Jupyter notebook data outputs.

Software Development Engineer in Test - The Climate Corporation

Dec 2014 - May 2016

- Built and executed automated test plans across web and mobile platforms within an agile development cycle.
- Contributed to the design and enhancement of internal tools and mobile test automation frameworks.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE: LEGAL OPERATIONS & REGULATORY LEADERSHIP

Legal Operations, Insurance & Regulatory Analysis (2001 - 2014)

The Climate Corporation (Senior Paralegal, 2011 - 2014): Defined business requirements for an automated insurance policy generation platform. Directed corporate and agency licensing programs, supported regulatory filings, managed due diligence data rooms for Series B/C fundraising and a $1B corporate acquisition, and administered corporate NDA/contract workflows.

Esurance (Senior Paralegal, 2008 - 2011): Executed regulatory compliance research, drafted corporate governance and Form B/C filings, and supported corporate information security review processes.

Fireman's Fund Insurance Company (Paralegal Manager & Specialist, 2005 - 2008): Managed regional paralegal personnel, coordinated resource allocation during corporate restructuring, and drafted reinsurance treaty contracts.

Vedder Price (Senior Paralegal, 2001-2003): Conducted legal research and reviewed insurance policy documentation; organized, reviewed, and managed large volumes of electronic and hard-copy documents; draft memoranda in support of motions and reservation of rights letters.

PROJECTS

Radio Atlas

github.com/solaranoir/radio-atlas

Full-stack amateur-radio intelligence platform converting live radio observations and NOAA space-weather telemetry into an interactive view of global RF propagation conditions. Built with Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, React, and TypeScript with automated ingestion pipelines and a 3D visualization globe.

Solara Radio Network

solararadio.netlify.app

Web suite integrating solar weather API information, satellite pass tool prediction, and Amateur Radio POTA tool in React.

Pocket Sat Test Lab

https://github.com/solaranoir/pocketsat-testlab

A Python Software/Hardware-in-the-Loop (SIL/HIL) test platform for a simulated spacecraft, a simulated RF channel, and an amateur-radio-style ground station.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Juris Doctor (J.D.) - University of Illinois College of Law
- Bachelor of Arts, Economics - Arizona State University
- Software Engineering Coursework - Arizona State University
- Japanese Language Studies - Soko Gakuen (San Francisco)
- Illinois State Bar Admission (Inactive)
- CPCU Exams Completed: 510, 520, 540, 552
- Amateur Radio Extra Class License: KK7QEA